



Seek Truth · Know Thyself · Serve Others

JOY ACADEMY ONLINE

Fall 2026 Teacher Letter

October 5, 2026 · Faith · Seek Truth · Know Thyself · Serve Others

Dear Teachers,

Greetings in the Lord! As autumn arrives, Joy Academy extends its warmest holiday greetings to you. May you be filled with joy, good health, and grace in your service!

It has been a month since the start of school. We are encouraged to see the focus, effort, and vibrant energy our students bring to their online classrooms. Thank you for your dedication and thoughtful guidance in every class!

At our recent **Curriculum Night**, we had the pleasure of gathering with parents to share the school's educational philosophy and discuss this semester's plans and hopes. We sincerely thank families for their attention and support. We would also like to share with you the key ideas we presented:

1. Our Mission: Nurturing a Godly Next Generation

Our educational mission is to nurture a Godly next generation, equipping students to become professionals in every field and the light and salt of the world. As teachers, you are not only transmitters of knowledge, but also shapers of young lives. We hope that as our students enter society, they will have strong professional abilities, steadfast faith, and good character, bringing light and blessing to the fields they serve.

2. Building a Strong, Transparent School

- **WASC accreditation application submitted:** This past summer, the school formally submitted its accreditation application to the Western Association of Schools and Colleges (WASC). This marks a milestone in our efforts to strengthen school operations, pursue international standards, and uphold rigorous academic management.

- **Our new official website is live:** We invite you to visit and bookmark joyacademy.online. The website offers course information, teaching updates, and important announcements, and serves as an important window into our school.

3. Updates to High School Academics and College Planning

This semester, we have further expanded our high school curriculum to support students' academic development and college planning at every grade level:

- **For 11th graders: College Counseling**
This course goes beyond test planning and college guidance; it invites students into a journey of self-discovery and seeking truth in their academic lives.
- **New advanced AP courses:** This semester we have added **AP Microeconomics** and **AP Calculus**, open to high school students who meet the enrollment requirements. These courses offer greater academic challenge and help students develop logical thinking and disciplined study habits.

4. Character Formation: The Cardinal Virtues and This Semester's Theme

Knowledge gives us power, while character gives us direction. This semester, we will continue to deepen our character education:

- **Practicing the Cardinal Virtues, alongside faith, hope, and love**
- **Deepening our semester theme — “We See Each Other”:** Our whole-school reading selection this semester is *Wonder*. We hope to bridge the distance created by screens and help students truly learn to “see each other” in online conversations and everyday interactions.

5. Our Hopes for Teachers

Students' growth in character and academic learning depends on the thoughtful guidance of every teacher. We especially hope you will:

1. **Set long-term goals:** Guide students in class to think and talk about long-term goals. Without a goal, a traveler may keep going in circles; with a goal, a climber can keep crossing new heights.

2. **Encourage mastery:** Help students understand that mastery is more than “knowing how”; it is being able to do something without having to stop and think it through each time. Mastery is not about one moment of perfection, but about consistent, dependable ability.
3. **Focus on the small details:** Details are not trivial; they are the only path to mastery.
4. **Pay attention to learning and relationships:** Focus on students' learning process, not only the results, and nurture their curiosity and motivation to learn independently. Maintain positive communication with families, stay attentive to students' emotional well-being, and work together to support their growth.

As Deuteronomy 8:2–3 says:

“Remember how the Lord your God led you all the way in the wilderness these forty years, to humble and test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep his commands. He humbled you, causing you to hunger and then feeding you with manna, which neither you nor your ancestors had known, to teach you that we do not live on bread alone but on every word that comes from the mouth of the Lord.”

May we remember together how God guides and shapes our students as they grow. May we care not only for their physical and academic needs, but also nurture their souls with God's Word and wisdom.

Education is a journey we take together. Thank you for your trust and partnership. Let us walk alongside one another this new semester and witness each student's growth in character and learning!

May the Lord's abundant grace fill you, and may you be blessed in your service!

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